A-A-2273
November 1, 1984

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BAG, PAPER GROCER'S (WET STRENGTH)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This description covers the requirements for kraft paper, wet strength, carry-out grocery bags.

Salient characteristics.

Materials used in the production of the grocer's bags shall conform to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

The paper shall be sized; the bags shall be self-opening style, fabricated from wet strength kraft, impregnated to resist moisture and prevent bursting under normal bagging conditions of wet and/or sweating products in high humidity areas. The paper shall conform to the following minimum requirements.

Characteristics	Minimum Requirements	TAPPI Method
Basis Weight (24 x 36 - 500)	60 Pounds	T410
Tear Resistance (MD)	120 Grams	T414
Dry Tensile Strength (CMD)	23.0 Pounds	T404
(Total)	66.0 Pounds	
Wet Tensile Strength (CMD)	6.2 Pounds	T456

The bag seams are to be glued over their full length with a fiber tearing bond to prevent leakage. The Pacific Region AFCOMS logo shall be printed to fully cover one side of the bag in blue color (see Figure 1 for logo). The capacity of the bag shall be 1386 cubic inches with a tolerance of minus 2, unlimited plus. The minimum bag dimension shall be 17-1/2 inches in length, 11-1/2 inches face width, and 7 inches bottom width (bag no. 1/6 bbl.). The bag shall be marked with the bag number as part of the manufacturer's trademark or imprint.

Sizing test. Test for sizing shall be in compliance with TAPPI Method T530 PM.

The issue of each TAPPI method in effect on the date of solicitation shall be used to determine compliance with these requirements.

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Cubic capacity. Method of measuring the bags and computing capacity (see Figure 2.)

Workmanship. Bags shall be uniformly constructed, free from holes, tears, cuts, or splits. All seams shall adhere securely throughout their area.

Examination of the end item for defects in workmanship. The sample unit for this examination shall be one bag. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 expressed in terms of percent defective in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

Regulatory requirements. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

Note. THE COMMERCIAL ITEM CERTIFICATION CLAUSE IS NOT REQUIRED WHEN THIS COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION IS USED FOR PROCUREMENT.

TAPPI test methods are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, Technology Park/Atlanta, P.O. Box 105113, Atlanta, GA 30348.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Air Force - 14

User Activity

Air Force - 14

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

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FIGURE 1

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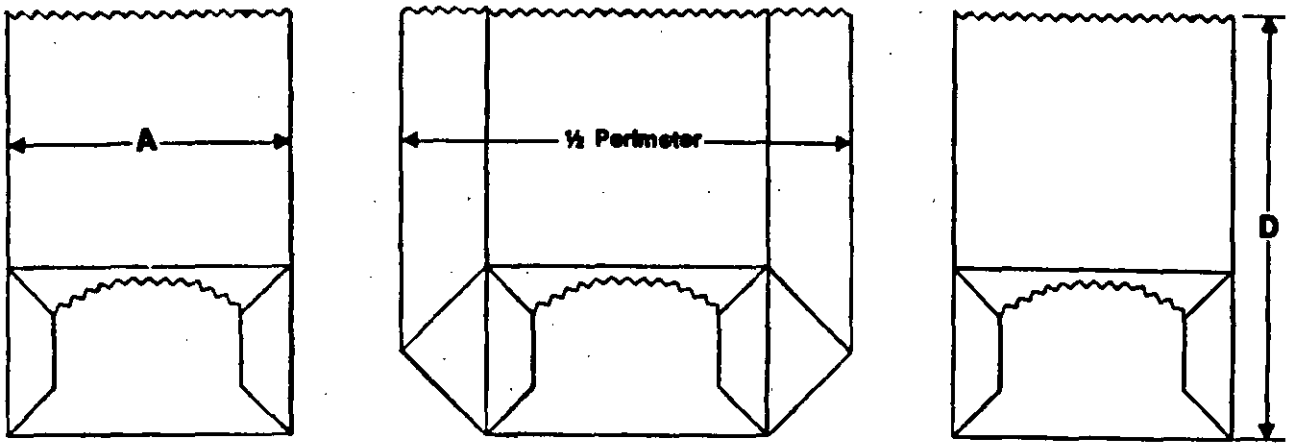


FIGURE I. Method of measuring self-opening (automatic) bags

Face width (A): Measure across the front of the folded bag just above the top of the bottom fold as shown in figure I.

Bottom width (C): Spread the bag so that the tucks normally behind the face are fully extended outward. Press the bag flat and measure full width as close to the bottom fold as possible. This gives one-half perimeter. Substracting the face width (A) from this measurement gives dimension (C).

Bag length (D): Measure along center of the front face of the bag from the lower bottom fold to the top of the serrated edge.

Cubic capacity is the product of the face width, bottom width, and bag length: AXCXD.

FIGURE 2

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